

RIBES

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Currant

GROSSULARIACEAE

Genus of deciduous or evergreen, mainly spring-flowering shrubs, grown for their edible fruits (currants and gooseberries) or their flowers. Fully to frost hardy. Needs full sun and well-drained, fertile soil, but *R. laurifolium* tolerates shade. After flowering, cut out some older shoots and, in winter or early spring, prune straggly, old plants hard. Propagate deciduous species by hardwood cuttings in winter, evergreens by semiripe cuttings in summer. Aphids attack young foliage.

R. aureum of gardens. See *R. odoratum*.

R. laurifolium illus. p.165.

R. odoratum, syn. *R. aureum* of gardens (Buffalo currant). Deciduous, upright shrub. H and S 6ft (2m). Bears pendent clusters of fragrant, tubular, golden-yellow flowers from mid- to late spring, then rounded, purple fruits. Rounded, 3-lobed, bright green leaves turn red and purple in fall. Z4-8

R. sanguineum (Flowering currant).

‘Brocklebankii’ is a deciduous, spreading shrub. H and S 4ft (1.2m). Has aromatic, pale yellow leaves. Pendent clusters of small, pale pink flowers, in spring, are followed by white-bloomed, black fruits.

‘Koja’ illus. p.146. **‘Pulborough Scarlet’** illus. p.123. **‘Tydeman’s White’**, H and S 8ft (2.5m), has pure white flowers.

WHITE ICICLE (‘Ubric’) is vigorous and early flowering, bearing pure white flowers. Z4-8

R. speciosum (Fuchsia-flowered currant) illus. p.193.

RICHEA

ERICACEAE/EPACRIDACEAE

Genus of evergreen, summer-flowering shrubs and small trees, grown for their foliage and densely clustered flowers. Frost to half hardy. Needs sun or partial shade and moist, peaty, neutral to acidic soil. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer or by seed in fall.

R. scoparia. Evergreen, upright shrub. H and S to 5ft (1.5m). Shoots are covered with narrowly lance-shaped, sharp-pointed, dark green leaves. Bears dense, upright spikes of small, egg-shaped, pink, white, orange or maroon flowers in early summer. Z8-11

RICINUS

EUPHORBIACEAE

Genus of one species of fast-growing, evergreen, treelike shrub, grown for its foliage. In cool climates is grown as an annual. Half hardy. Needs sun and fertile to rich, well-drained soil. May require support in exposed areas. Propagate by seed sown under glass in early spring. ☉ All parts of *R. communis*, particularly the seeds, are highly toxic if ingested; contact with the foliage may aggravate skin allergies.

R. communis (Castor-oil plant) illus. p.318. **‘Impala’** illus. p.308.

ROBINIA

PAPILIONACEAE/LEGUMINOSAE

Genus of deciduous, mainly summer-flowering trees and shrubs, grown for their foliage and clusters of pealike flowers. Useful for poor, dry soil. Fully hardy. Needs a sunny position. Grows in any but waterlogged soil. Branches are brittle and may be damaged by strong winds. Propagate by seed or suckers in fall or by root cuttings in winter. ☉ All parts may cause severe discomfort if ingested.

R. x ambigua ‘Decaisneana’.

Deciduous, spreading tree. H 50ft (15m), S 30ft (10m). Dark green leaves have numerous ovate leaflets. Long, hanging clusters of pealike, pink flowers are borne in early summer. Z4-8

R. hispida (Rose acacia) illus. p.133.

R. pseudoacacia (False acacia, Locust).

Fast-growing, deciduous, spreading tree. H 80ft (25m), S 50ft (15m). Dark green leaves consist of 11-23 ovate leaflets. Bears dense, drooping clusters of fragrant, pealike, white flowers in late spring and early summer. Z3-8. **‘Frisia’** illus. p.76. **‘Inermis’** see *R.p. ‘Umbraculifera’*. **‘Lace Lady’** (syn. *R.p. ‘Twisty Baby’*), H 12-20ft (4-6m), S 15-22ft (5-7m), is slow-growing and shrubby, with few thorns. Young growths are twisted and contorted, and older leaves may be wavy or curled. Rarely flowers. Suitable for a container.

‘Twisty Baby’ see *R.p. ‘Lace Lady’*.

‘Umbraculifera’ (syn. *R.p. ‘Inermis’*; Mop-head acacia), H and S 20ft (6m), rarely produces a rounded, dense flower head.

R. x slaviniii ‘Hillieri’ illus. p.86.

Rochea coccinea. See *Crassula coccinea*.

RODGERSIA

SAXIFRAGACEAE

Genus of summer-flowering, rhizomatous perennials, ideal for pond sides. Fully hardy. Grows in sun or partial shade and in soil that is moist; requires shelter from strong winds, which may damage foliage. Propagate by division in spring or by seed in fall.

R. aesculifolia illus. p.437.

R. pinnata ‘Fireworks’. Clump-forming, rhizomatous perennial. H 3ft (1m), S 2ft (60cm). Has a large creeping root and large, pinnate, red-tinged, mid-green leaves with narrowly ovate leaflets. In summer, produces much-branched, loose panicles of small, star-shaped, pink-red flowers. Z5-7. **‘Superba’**, H 3-4ft (1-1.2m), S 75cm (2½ft), has bronze-tinged, emerald-green leaves and bright pink flowers.

R. podophylla illus. p.436.

R. sambucifolia illus. p.437.

R. tabularis. See *Astilboides tabularis*.

ROMNEYA

Tree poppy

PAPAVERACEAE

Genus of summer-flowering, woody-based perennials and deciduous subshrubs. Fully hardy. Requires a warm, sunny position and deep, well-drained soil. Difficult to

establish, resents being moved and, in very cold areas, roots may need protection in winter. Once established, may spread rapidly. Propagate by softwood cuttings of basal shoots in early spring, by seed in fall (transplanting seedlings without disturbing rootballs), or by root cuttings in winter.

R. coulteri (Tree poppy) illus. p.216.

‘White Cloud’ is a vigorous, bushy, woody-based perennial. H 3-8ft (1-2.5m), S indefinite. Throughout summer, bears large, slightly fragrant, shallowly cup-shaped, white flowers with prominent golden stamens. Leaves are ovate, deeply lobed, and gray. Z7-10

ROMULEA

IRIDACEAE

Genus of crocuslike corms, grown for their funnel-shaped flowers. Frost to half hardy. Needs full light and well-drained, sandy soil. Water freely during the growing period. Most species die down in summer and then need warmth and dryness, but *R. macowanii* is dormant in winter. Propagate by seed in fall, or in spring for *R. macowanii*.

R. bulbocodioides of gardens. See *R. flava*.

R. bulbocodium illus. p.419.

R. flava, syn. *R. bulbocodioides* of gardens. Early spring-flowering corm. H to 4in (10cm), S 2in (5cm). Has a threadlike, erect, basal leaf and 1-5 upright, widely funnel-shaped, usually yellowish green flowers, ¾-1½in (2-4cm) across, with deeper yellow centers. Z10-11 **R. longituba**. See *R. macowanii* var. *alticola*.

R. macowanii var. *alticola*, syn.

R. longituba. Summer-flowering corm. H 3in (8cm), S 2in (5cm). Leaves are threadlike, erect and basal. Produces 1-3 upright, yellow flowers, each 1¼in (3cm) across, with a long tube expanding to become a wide funnel shape. Z9-11 **R. sabulosa**. Early spring-flowering corm. H 4-8in (10-20cm), S 2in (5cm). Has threadlike, erect, basal leaves. Stems bear 1-4 upward-facing, funnel-shaped, black-centered, bright red flowers that open flatish, to 1½-2in (4-5cm) across, in the sun. Z10-11

RONDELETIA

RUBIACEAE

Genus of evergreen, mainly summer-flowering trees and shrubs, grown mainly for their flowers. Frost tender. Requires full light or partial shade and fertile, well-drained soil. Water containerized specimens freely when in full growth, moderately at other times. Stems may be shortened in early spring if necessary. Propagate by seed in spring or by semiripe cuttings in summer.

R. amoena. Evergreen, rounded shrub. H and S 6-12ft (2-4m). Ovate, dark green leaves are brown-hairy beneath. Produces dense clusters of tubular, 4-or 5-lobed, pink or white flowers with bearded yellow throats in summer. Z11-12 (min. 54°F/12°C) **Rooksbya euphorbioides**. See *Neobuxbaumia euphorbioides*.

ROSA

Rose

ROSACEAE

Genus of deciduous or semievergreen, open shrubs and scrambling climbers, grown for their profusion of flowers, often fragrant, and sometimes for their fruits (rose hips). Leaves are divided into usually 5 or 7 ovate leaflets, with rounded or pointed tips, that are sometimes toothed. Stems usually bear prickles. Fully hardy, unless otherwise stated below. Prefers an open, sunny site and requires fertile, moist but well-drained soil. Avoid planting in an area where roses have been grown in recent years, as problems due to harmful organisms may occur: either exchange the soil, which may be used satisfactorily elsewhere, or choose another site for the new rose. To obtain blooms of high quality, feed in late winter or early spring with a balanced fertilizer and apply a mulch. In spring and summer, feed regularly at 3-weekly intervals. Remove spent flower heads from plants that are “remontant” (“rising up again;” other terms used are repeat- or perpetual-flowering). May be trimmed for tidiness in early winter. To improve health, flower quality, and shape of bush, prune in the dormant season or, preferably, in early spring, before young shoots develop from dormant growth buds: remove dead, damaged, and dying wood; lightly trim Old Garden and Groundcover roses (see below); remove two-thirds of previous summer’s growth of Modern bush, including miniature, roses. Correct treatment of Modern shrub and climbing roses, ramblers, and Species roses depends on the individual cultivar, but in general they should be pruned only lightly. Propagate by budding in summer or by hardwood cuttings in fall. All roses are prone to attack by various pests and diseases, including aphids, blackspot, powdery mildew, rust, and sawfly.

Rose species and cultivars are often regarded as 2 separate groups. Cultivars are further divided into Old Garden and Modern roses. Each group comprises different types, based, it is claimed, on the functional qualities of each plant, such as whether it is repeat-flowering, rather than on any historical, botanical, or genetical relationships. Flowers occur in a variety of forms (illustrated and described on p.172) and are single (4-7 petals), semidouble (8-20 petals), double (20-30 petals) or fully double (over 30 petals).

Many modern rose cultivars are sold under names other than the registered Plant Breeder’s Rights (PBR) names; where this is the case, the plant is listed under its trade name, with the PBR name in brackets. Roses are illustrated on pp.172-87.

Species roses

Species, or wild, roses (including those interspecific hybrids that share most of the characteristics of their parent species) are either shrubs or climbers, mostly bearing single, 5-petaled, often fragrant flowers in summer, usually in one flush on short shoots from second-year wood: the flowers are followed by red, black, green, yellow, orange, or purple hips in fall.